

Hero — Motion & Interaction Brief for Claude Design

Section: Landing page hero ("Whose brand is it, anyway?") **Handoff includes:** Figma frames ([hero](#), [hero-interaction](#)) + individual ad PNGs (one **color** and one **desaturated** version per ad). **Status:** AI-generated draft spec for build. Read alongside the two reference frames.

The one thing to get right

Each ad has **two PNGs that are not the same crop** — the color version and the B&W version were recomposed independently (different framing, different focal point). So every transition between color and desat, whether on load or on hover, must be a **crossfade between two stacked image layers**, never a filter toggle or a single-image swap. The crossfade is what smooths the crop mismatch. If you `filter: grayscale()` a single image instead, the recomposed crops are lost and the mismatch never gets hidden. This applies identically to the load animation and the hover interaction.

Asset & DOM model

Build each ad tile as a container with two absolutely-positioned, stacked layers:

- `.tile` — the container. Owns border-radius, drop shadow, resting **opacity: 0.75**, the parallax transform, and the hover lift transform. Assign each tile a `data-depth` (see Parallax) and `aria-hidden="true"` (tiles are decorative).
- `.tile .layer-color` — the colorized PNG, `object-fit: cover`, fills the tile.
- `.tile .layer-desat` — the B&W PNG, same box, stacked on top.

Only `opacity` animates between the two layers. Keep both layers mounted at all times; do not swap `src`.

Positions, sizes, rotations, and z-order come from the Figma frames. It's a scattered collage around the centered text, not a grid — respect the exact placement in [hero](#).

State sequence

1. Load — everything in color. Tiles enter staggered: `opacity 0 → 0.75`, `translateY(16px) → 0`. 600ms, `cubic-bezier(.2, .7, .2, 1)`, **60ms stagger** between tiles. At rest they sit at 75% opacity so they never compete with the headline. `.layer-desat` starts at `opacity: 0`.

2. Auto-desaturate — the brand quietly leaves. After the last tile finishes entering, hold ~500ms, then crossfade each tile from color to desat, **one at a time, in randomized order** so it feels organic rather than mechanical.

Per-tile crossfade (this is the shared mechanism):

- `.layer-color opacity 1 → 0`
- `.layer-desat opacity 0 → 1`
- Duration **700ms**, easing `ease-in-out`.
- To further mask the crop shift: give `.layer-color` a `transform: scale(1) → scale(1.015)` over the same window, and optionally a `filter: blur(0 → 1.2px)` that peaks near the midpoint and settles. Keep the blur subtle; it exists only to soften the edge between two differently-cropped frames.
- **Stagger 90–130ms** (randomized within that range) between tiles.

3. Rest — all desat, 75% opacity. This is the steady state a scrolling reader passes through.

4. Hover — the reader restores the brand. On pointer enter of a tile, crossfade it **back to color** using the same two-layer mechanism in reverse:

- `.layer-desat opacity 1 → 0`, `.layer-color opacity 0 → 1`.
- Crossfade **350ms**, `ease-out` (faster in than the fade-out, so restoring feels responsive).
- Simultaneously lift the tile: `opacity 0.75 → 1`, `scale → 1.04`, deepen the shadow.

On pointer leave, reverse: crossfade back to desat over **500ms** `ease-in` (slightly slower — the brand "fades back to anonymous"), and drop the lift.

Optional but recommended: light up **immediate neighbors** at reduced intensity (e.g. a tile within a ~140px radius of the cursor gets a partial restore, `opacity 0.85`, no scale). This turns discrete hovers into a soft lens sweep and feels less binary. Ship per-tile first; add the radius if it reads well.

Parallax

Subtle depth on the collage, driven by cursor position (desktop) and scroll.

- Assign **data-depth** per tile, roughly **0.02–0.08**. Larger tiles / foreground tiles get more; small distant ones get less. Vary by hand so it doesn't feel uniform.
- **Cursor parallax**: translate each tile opposite the cursor, **offset = (cursorFromCenter) * depth**, clamped to a **max ~16px**. Lerp the current offset toward the target at ~0.08/frame so it trails smoothly rather than tracking 1:1.
- **Scroll parallax**: as the hero scrolls out of view, translate tiles vertically by **scrollY * depth** (again small). The headline block should move less than the tiles so the text stays anchored longest.
- Compose transforms carefully. The tile's **transform** carries parallax translate **and** the hover scale — write them into a single transform string (e.g. **translate3d(px, py, 0) scale(s)**), or nest a **.tile-inner** for scale so the two don't clobber each other.
- Use **translate3d** and **will-change: transform** on tiles for GPU compositing. Throttle cursor + scroll handling through a single **requestAnimationFrame** loop.

Timing summary

Beat	Property	Duration	Easing	Stagger
Entrance	opacity 0→.75, translateY 16→0	600ms	cubic-bezier(.2,.7,.2,1)	60ms
Hold before desat	—	~500ms	—	—
Auto-desaturate	color↔desat crossfade (+ scale 1→1.015, blur pulse)	700ms	ease-in-out	90–130ms random
Hover in	desat→color crossfade, lift, scale→1.04	350ms	ease-out	—
Hover out	color→desat crossfade, drop lift	500ms	ease-in	—

Beat	Property	Duration	Easing	Stagger
Parallax follow	transform lerp	~0.08/frame	—	—

Responsive

- **Desktop (fine pointer):** full behavior as above; hover + cursor parallax active.
- **Tablet / mobile (no hover, coarse pointer):** no cursor parallax and no per-tile hover. Instead, keep the load → auto-desaturate beat, then let a soft "lens" **roam slowly and ambiently** across the collage restoring tiles it passes, so the effect still reads without a cursor. Reduce tile count and reflow positions so nothing sits under the headline or subhead at narrow widths — reposition per a dedicated mobile frame rather than scaling the desktop scatter.
- Scroll parallax can stay on mobile at reduced magnitude, or off if it costs frames.

Accessibility & performance

- **prefers-reduced-motion: reduce:** skip the entrance, the auto-desaturate animation, and all parallax. Render tiles **static in their desat state** at 75% opacity. Hover restore may remain (it's user-initiated and brief) but with an instant/very short crossfade, no scale, no parallax.
- Tiles are decorative: **aria-hidden="true"**, not focusable. The headline, subhead, and eyebrow are the real content and must remain fully legible and selectable above the collage at all breakpoints.
- Target 60fps: composite only **transform** and **opacity**, cap the blur (it's the most expensive part — consider dropping it on lower-end devices or gating behind a quick FPS check), and keep the rAF loop to one shared instance.
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